



Report to the Legislature on the Genocide Education Trust Fund and Programming: FY2025

Through state budget line item 1595-0116, the Genocide Education Trust Fund promotes the instruction of middle and high school students on the history of genocide.

October 2025

This document was prepared by the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education

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October 1, 2025

Dear Members of the General Court:

I am pleased to submit this Report to the Legislature: *Genocide Education Trust Fund and Programming: FY2025*. The Department of Elementary and Secondary Education's genocide education work is based on [Chapter 98 of the Acts of 2021](#), *An act concerning genocide education*, which directs the Department to establish a grant program to support instruction on the history of genocide at the middle and high school levels. Chapter 98 also established a Genocide Education Trust Fund for the purposes of educating middle and high school students on the history of genocide and to assist in promoting the teaching of human rights issues in all public schools and school districts, with particular attention to the study of the inhumanity of genocide.

This report is pursuant to Chapter 98, which stipulates:

"...the commissioner of elementary and secondary education shall report to the clerks of the house of representatives and the senate, the joint committee on education and the house and senate committees on ways and means on the fund's activities. The report shall include, but not be limited to: (i) the source and amount of funds received; (ii) the expenditures made from the fund and the purposes of such expenditures; (iii) any grants provided to relevant community stakeholders and other stakeholder organizations; (iv) anticipated revenue and expenditure projections for the next fiscal year; (v) the number of schools and school districts that have used the fund to implement a new program or enhance or maintain current programming; and (vi) the number of schools and school districts that applied for, but were not granted, funding. The report shall be publicly available on the department's website."

Chapter 98 also requires that:

"...the commissioner shall provide a report on the progress of genocide education programs in public schools and school districts to the clerks of the house of representatives and the senate and the joint committee on education. The report shall provide a description of the manner in which grantees...are offering genocide instruction including: (i) the number of hours of instruction offered; (ii) the grade levels at which such instruction is offered; and (iii) the title and description of the course in which such instruction is integrated."

During FY2025, the Department continued to offer the Genocide Education Grant, which provided 42 Local Education Agencies with the funds to expand and deepen their instruction in the history and patterns of genocide. In this report, we summarize findings based on the participation of these LEAs in a statewide evaluation of genocide education as well as a review of their grant applications.

As we move into FY2026, the need for education to combat hate and recognize the mistakes of the past has continued to be urgent. With the Legislature's allocation of \$3 million to the Genocide Education Trust Fund in FY2026, the Department is grateful to be able to provide additional grant funding and resources to further this important work.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Pedro Martinez", with a long, sweeping horizontal line extending from the end of the name.

Pedro Martinez
Commissioner of Elementary and Secondary Education

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Introduction

The Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (Department) respectfully submits this Report to the Legislature: *Genocide Education Trust Fund: FY2025*, pursuant to [Chapter 98 of the Acts of 2021](#), which stipulates:

“There is hereby established and set up on the books of the commonwealth a separate fund to be known as the Genocide Education Trust Fund for the purpose of educating middle and high school students on the history of genocide...the commissioner of elementary and secondary education shall report to the clerks of the house of representatives and the senate, the joint committee on education and the house and senate committees on ways and means on the fund’s activities.”

As stated above, the Genocide Education Trust Fund is intended to strengthen instruction on the history of genocide for middle and high school students. More specifically, Chapter 98 requires that every school district, to educate middle and high school students, provide instruction on the history of genocide consistent with the content standards articulated in the [History/Social Science Curriculum Framework](#).

In FY2025, the state legislature appropriated \$3 million for the Genocide Education Trust Fund to strengthen instruction in the history and patterns of genocide. Per Chapter 98, the Genocide Education Trust Fund may be used:

- to develop curricular materials detailing the underlying causes, international reaction, progression, and aftermath of genocide; and
- to provide and supply professional development trainings, seminars, conferences, and materials, for educators to use in the teaching of genocide.

The Trust Fund may also be used for other purposes related to instructing middle and high school students on the history of genocide, as long as at least 50 percent of the funds expended annually are allocated to public schools or school districts.

During FY2025, the Trust Fund was used to offer the Genocide Education Grant. This grant provided 42 Local Education Agencies with the funds to expand and deepen their instruction in the history and patterns of genocide. In addition, funds were used to support an evaluation of the Genocide Education Grant and to conduct a landscape analysis of genocide education instruction across Massachusetts.

Report on the Genocide Education Trust Fund

Summary of Major Trust Fund Revenue and Expenditures

Per Chapter 98, this section includes a description of:

- the source and amount of funds received in FY2025;
- the expenditures made from the fund in FY2025 and the purposes of such expenditures;
- any grants provided to relevant community stakeholders and other stakeholder organizations in FY2025, including:
 - the number of schools and school districts that have used the fund to implement a new program or enhance or maintain current programming in FY2025;
 - the number of schools and school districts that applied for, but were not granted, funding in FY2025; and
 - anticipated revenue and expenditure projections for FY2026.

FY2025 Funds Received

In its FY2025 budget, the state appropriated \$3,000,000 for the Genocide Education Trust Fund. No other funds were received by the Genocide Education Trust Fund this year.

FY2025 Expenditures

In FY2025, the Department used the Genocide Education Trust Fund to provide direct grant awards to local education agencies (LEAs) as well as to fund several key projects intended to strengthen genocide education, as follows (information accurate as of August 11, 2025):

	Expenditures
Grant Awards	\$1,138,321.00
Genocide Education Grant (FC 215/215a)	\$1,138,321.00
<i>Returned funds from grantees</i>	<i>(\$58,975.00)</i>
Project Expenses	\$908,196.75
Administrative Expenses	\$10,558.67
Consultant Services	\$805,454.56
Pension & Insurance Related Expenses	\$1,414.78
Special Employees	\$90,768.74
Total Expended (as of August 11, 2025)	\$2,046,517.75

FY2026 Revenue and Major Expenditure Projections

In its FY2026 budget, the state appropriated \$3 million to the Genocide Education Trust Fund. The Department is not aware of any anticipated additional revenue that the Trust Fund will receive this fiscal year.

Significant spending through FY2026 will include continued funding to LEAs awarded grants in Summer 2025, further funding for genocide education evaluation, and additional funds for genocide education resource development and employee costs. Estimated expenditures on these projects are listed below:

	FY26 Projected Expenditure Estimates
Grants to Public Entities	\$1,462,622.00
Genocide Education Grant (FC 215)	\$1,462,622.00
Project Expenses	\$ 198,696.00
Resource Development	\$ 80,000.00
Genocide Education Evaluation	\$26,946.00
Employee Costs	\$91,750.00
Total Estimated FY2026 Expenditures	\$1,661,318.00

Detailed Report on FY2025 Trust Fund Spending

Grant Awards

FC215/FC215a: Genocide Education Grant

Massachusetts LEAs were eligible to apply for Cycle 2 funding in FY2024 (FC 215a), with awardees having the option to divide their funds between FY2024 and FY2025. Those recommended for funding most closely met the criteria outlined in the [Funding Opportunity RFP document](#). 43 LEAs were awarded funds across FY2024 and FY2025, with 42 receiving funds for FY2025. Four proposals were not funded due to incomplete information or a lack of alignment with the priorities of the RFP.

The grant was intended to support LEAs in strengthening instruction in the history and patterns of genocide. Priority was given to LEAs with schools requiring assistance according to the state accountability system and/or where greater than 40 percent of the student population was designated as low-income. Grant applications were also prioritized based on:

1. **Aligned, meaningful learning opportunities:** Proposals that aligned materials, curriculum, professional development, and/or experiential learning opportunities to the History and Social Science Framework and the goals outlined in Chapter 98 of the Acts of 2021, *An act concerning genocide education*. Meaningful

learning experiences that were well-integrated into existing instruction were prioritized.

2. **Equity:** Proposals that increased equitable access to high-quality genocide education for all students were preferred.
3. **Sustainability:** Proposals that led to sustainable, long-term impact were preferred over “one-off” opportunities.
4. **Partnership:** Preferred proposals included opportunities to collaborate with relevant organizations and/or engage local community members.

Ultimately, the funded projects included several activities such as partnering with external organizations to conduct professional development for teachers, supporting teams of history teachers in incorporating high-quality instruction on genocide into their existing curriculum, and taking field trips to relevant destinations. The Department awarded \$1,204,192, and approximately \$1,138,321 was spent in FY2025.

A list of grant recipients can be found in Appendix A.

Project Expenses

Administrative Expenses, Pension & Insurance Related Expenses, Special Employees

To expand the Department’s capacity to support educators with Genocide Education, a contractor was hired to manage the Genocide Education grant cycle and evaluation. Associated expenses, as well as indirect cost expenditures, were \$102,742.19 in FY25.

Consultant Services

In partnership with research organization MC² Education, the Department continued a genocide education evaluation. This statewide study includes an evaluation of the Genocide Education Grant as well as a landscape analysis of the current state of genocide education instruction across the state. In FY2025, total expenditures for this project were \$908,196.75.

The Department also contracted with Harvard University to provide professional development to history and social science teachers and leaders, at a cost of \$396,728.97. Finally, the Department worked with multiple contracted vendors to produce the Investigating History curriculum, which is used in hundreds of middle school classrooms across the state and addresses genocide alongside other topics as indicated by the History and Social Science Curriculum Framework. \$41,193.00 from the Genocide Education Trust Fund was used towards this project.

Looking Ahead: Major FY2026 Expenditures

In FY2026, the Department will continue to fund the genocide education evaluation, specifically for grant monitoring. The Department will begin to use Genocide Education Trust Fund funds to design additional supports and resources for genocide education. Alongside these projects, the Department plans to continue offering grant funding to support districts' efforts to strengthen genocide education. Additionally, the Department will continue to employ a contract employee to coordinate all these projects.

Grantees' Genocide Education Programming in FY2025

The remainder of this report will describe genocide education instruction offered by recipients of the Genocide Education Grant, including:

- the number of hours of instruction offered,
- the grade levels at which such instruction is offered, and
- the title and description of the course in which such instruction is integrated.

All FY25 grantees received a survey from research organization MC² Education as part of a Department-sponsored statewide evaluation of genocide education. Of those grant recipients, 24 (57%) responded to the survey. However, not every grantee provided all the requested information.

Grade Levels

All grantee respondents (20) offered instruction in topics related to genocide across all secondary grade levels, with the most frequent instruction occurring in grades 9, 10, and 11. Responding grantees indicated offering an average of 2.6 courses across the LEA that included instruction in genocide.

Below is a table showing the number of responding grantee respondents offering genocide education as part of required instruction at the indicated grade level.

Grade Level	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Number of Grantee Respondents Reporting Instruction at this Grade Level	6	8	9	11	10	11	2

Source: MC2 Education, 2025

The following is a chart indicating the number of responding grantee respondents offering genocide education as part of elective instruction at a given grade level.

Grade Level	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
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Number of Grantee Respondents Reporting Instruction at this Grade Level	2	0	0	3	7	11	13
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Source: MC2 Education, 2025

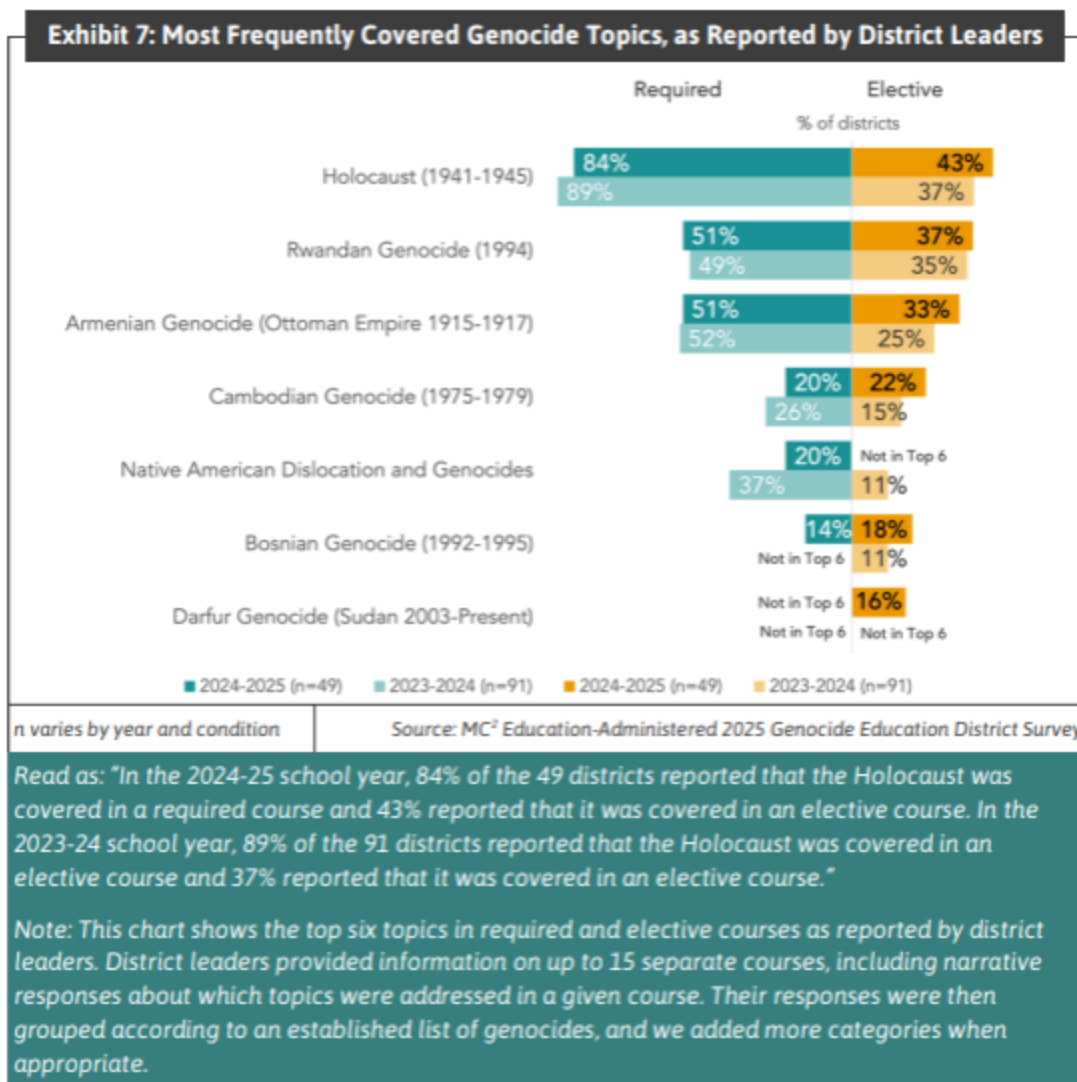
Instructional Hours

Of those that reported instructional hours, LEAs offered an average of 95.6 hours related to genocide education.

Courses and Topics of Instruction

LEAs offered instruction in genocide across a variety of courses, including both required and elective courses. 98% of responding grantees reported including topics of genocide within mandatory courses in history and social studies. Instruction was most frequently offered in required high school ELA and history courses (US History I/II and World History I/II).

Within these courses, LEAs referenced the teaching of several specific genocides. The table below highlights the top seven genocide education topics covered in required and elective courses. (These topics were identified by LEAs within an open-ended survey question.)



Source: MC2 Education, 2025

Summary

Through its work in FY2025, the Department has leveraged the Genocide Education Trust Fund to continue opportunities for teachers and students to learn vitally important history to support students' development and ability to confront injustice and make informed decisions. As evidenced by the data shared in this report, LEAs have continued to take advantage of these opportunities to expand and deepen their instruction surrounding the history and patterns of genocide. We look forward to continuing this work in FY2026.

Appendix A: FY2025 Genocide Education Grant Recipients

Awarded in FY24-25 Cycle 2 (ended in June 2025)

	Award Amount
Andover	\$40,000
Arlington	\$39,500
Boston Collegiate Charter	\$20,000
Bridge Boston Charter	\$20,000
Brookline	\$60,000
Cambridge	\$60,000
Codman Academy	\$16,000
Community Day Charter	\$36,225
Collaborative for Regional Educational Service and Training	\$20,000
Essex North Shore Agricultural and Technical School District	\$15,000
Fitchburg	\$40,000
Gloucester	\$40,000
Hadley	\$1,900
Haverhill	\$60,000
Holliston	\$31,150
Holyoke	\$33,700
Littleton	\$40,000
Lynn	\$60,000
Lynnfield	\$40,000
Malden	\$40,069
Manchester Essex Regional School District	\$30,000
Marshfield	\$15,300
Mashpee	\$21,600
Mendon-Upton	\$39,370
New Heights Charter	\$6,000
Newburyport	\$40,000
Newton	\$59,750
North Andover	\$39,500
Northampton	\$18,400
Northborough and Southborough (joint award)	\$20,000
Northboro-Southboro	\$16,500
Peabody	\$60,000
Phoenix Charter Academy	\$20,000
Randolph	\$15,390

Salem	\$15,085
Shrewsbury	\$19,320
Somerset Berkley Regional School District	\$20,000
South Shore Charter	\$40,000
Southeastern Regional Vocational technical	\$29,250
Stoneham	\$40,000
Woburn	\$14,080
Worcester	\$50,000
Total Awards	\$1,343,089
